

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS



INDIA – AFRICA – 2

MODULE – 45

MULTILATERAL COOPERATION

- 1 Africa remains vital for India's emergence as a global actor in the international institutional arena.
- 2 Both India and Africa are keen to reform the existing global governance structures, especially the U.N. Security Council (UNSC), and shape the emerging global regimes.
- 3 NAM provided a sense of solidarity and belonging to the newly independent African states and was the first effort at South-South cooperation.
- 4 By 2008, India had emerged as the largest contributor to UN mandated operations in Africa, with a cumulative effort totaling more than 30,000 personnel involved in peacekeeping, humanitarian, and electoral missions.



MULTILATERAL COOPERATION

5 India participated in United Nations peacekeeping missions in Congo, Somalia, Liberia, Burundi and Sudan. India also provided support for African Union initiatives to bring peace to Somalia and Mali, among others

6 India cooperates with Africa on several forums like IBSA, BRICS, Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation (IOR – ARC)

7 In March 2015, Indian Prime Minister visited Seychelles and Mauritius, signaling India's intent to enhance ties with the African Indian Ocean Rim Countries

8 India is a 'development partner' of Africa and has placed a growing emphasis on this to ensure it continues to develop sustainable manner.



MULTILATERAL COOPERATION

BRICS SUMMIT

- 1 Prime Minister Modi visited Rwanda, Uganda and South Africa in July 2018 as a part of the BRICS Summit. It reiterated the importance of Africa for India.
- 2 By this visit, India made itself visible in the continent. It reflected Africa's growing importance in India's foreign policy.

It highlighted several points:

- Need for enhancing mutual security was emphasized.
- Free and Open trade and reform of the global order was encouraged.
- Emphasis was laid on empowering youth especially the women.



CHINA FACTOR

- 1 Increased presence of China in Africa further threatens Indian interests in this region.
- 2 Not only that, recently inaugurated Chinese military base in Djibouti undermines Indian position in the Arabian Sea and poses a threat to the sea line of communication in Gulf of Aden, which holds significance for Indian trade and commercial activities.
- 3 China is investing heavily in African infrastructure by building ports in Africa and building railway line to connect the ports to the railway lines; mining, oil and natural gas.
- 4 India lacks the material capabilities and the profile to emulate or directly compete with China in Africa.



CHINA FACTOR

INDIA'S ADVANTAGES VIS-S-VIS CHINA

- 1** India has an upper hand in Africa as it uses African labor and it suits well with the needs of the African community. China, on the other hand, uses its own labor for infrastructural activities in Africa.
- 2** India and Africa share a geographical proximity. Mumbai to Johannesburg is around nine hours journey. There are, however, no direct flights linking Johannesburg with Shanghai or Beijing.
- 3** India's local government institutions and judicial system is based on the rule of law. India can share its unique expertise through technical cooperation where it outranks
- 4** Africans regard Chinese as neo colonialists. Indian businesses have encountered fewer suspicions.
- 5** Thus, instead of emulating China or, on the other hand, India should identify attributes that distinguish it positively from China and that could therefore be explored as a strategic advantage in the long run.



SECURITY CONCERNS

- 1** India shares the waters of the Indian Ocean with Africa and there are security threats emerging from Africa that not only impact the African nations but also have a strong bearing on India.
- 2** The troubling links between Somali and other groups such as the al-Qaida affiliated al-Shabab and militant groups in the Afghanistan and Pakistan region could significantly threaten India's future security.
- 3** International terrorism has been on the rise in Africa in recent years, extending from Nigeria in West Africa to Somalia in the Horn of Africa.



SECURITY CONCERNS

- 4 Africa is critical to India's security especially Horn of Africa because of its proximity to India.
- 5 There is threat of piracy and organised crime.
- 6 The piracy threat along the Somali and East African coast, often stretching wide across the ocean, offers the Indian Navy a lucrative opportunity to develop its blue water ambitions.
- 7 Maritime security challenges such as piracy and illegal, unregulated and unreported fishing are important areas of concern.



INDIA-AFRICA FORUM SUMMIT

- 1 India entered into a structured engagement with African countries with the India-Africa Forum Summit (IAFS). It is the official platform for the African-Indian relations.
- 2 The first such Summit took place in 2008 in New Delhi and is held once in three years
- 3 The second summit took place in Addis Ababa (2011)
- 4 In 2015, 3rd India-Africa Forum Summit took place in New Delhi
- 5 PM Modi announced a \$10 billion lines of credit along with a \$100 million Indian Development Fund



INDIA-AFRICA FORUM SUMMIT

6 \$ 500 million in Grants apart from 50,000 scholarships for capacity-building and education.

7 It brought forth two important documents, the Delhi Declaration and the India-Africa Framework for Strategic Cooperation. Both documents offer a direction for Indo-African relations in the coming years.

8 They provide a framework for the establishment of a long-term and stable partnership of equality and mutual benefit between India and Africa.

9 They also serve as a blueprint for India-Africa co-operation in political, economic, social, science and technology, cultural, security and other fields.



INDIA-AFRICA FORUM SUMMIT

REFORM OF UNITED NATIONS SECURITY COUNCIL

- 1** The Summit sought a decisive push for reform of United Nations Security Council.
- 2** India noted the common African position and the aspirations of the African countries to “get their rightful place” in an expanded UN Security Council as new permanent members
- 3** Africa acknowledged India’s position and its aspirations to become a permanent member with full rights in the security council.
- 4** The leaders emphasized the need for an early implementation of the UNGA Decision 69/56 to push for reforms in UN Security Council



INDIA-AFRICA FORUM SUMMIT

COUNTER-TERRORISM ACTIVITIES

- 1 The declaration said the India and Africa will promote strengthening of the UN counter-terrorism mechanisms
- 2 They called upon all states to ensure strict compliance with the UN Security Council sanctions regime on terrorism
- 3 Calling on countries to ensure that “their territories are not used for cross-border terrorist activities,”

CLIMATE CHANGE AGREEMENT

The declaration said that India and Africa looked forward to finalizing an ambitious and comprehensive climate change agreement “based on the principles of equity and common but differentiated responsibility.”



PM MODI AT UGANDA PARLIAMENT

- 1 In July 2018, PM Modi, addressed the Parliament in Kampala, the first ever by an Indian Prime Minister
- 2 He said Uganda is the pearl of Africa and a land of great wealth of resources and rich heritage
- 3 He outlined his Africa vision through his ten guiding principles which include:
 1. development partnership as per African priorities
 2. preferential access to Indian markets for African products
 3. assist in harnessing digital revolution in Africa
 4. improve Africa's agriculture potential
 5. fight climate change together
 6. work together to keep oceans and maritime lanes free for all
 7. Work for the development of youth
 8. work together for a just , representative, democratic global order.



PM MODI AT UGANDA PARLIAMENT

4 PM referred to India and Africa's connect through Mahatma Gandhi and India's independence; Afro-Asian solidarity in Bandung and opposition to apartheid in South Africa

5 PM Modi also participated in the India-Uganda Business forum and encouraged higher Ugandan exports to India.

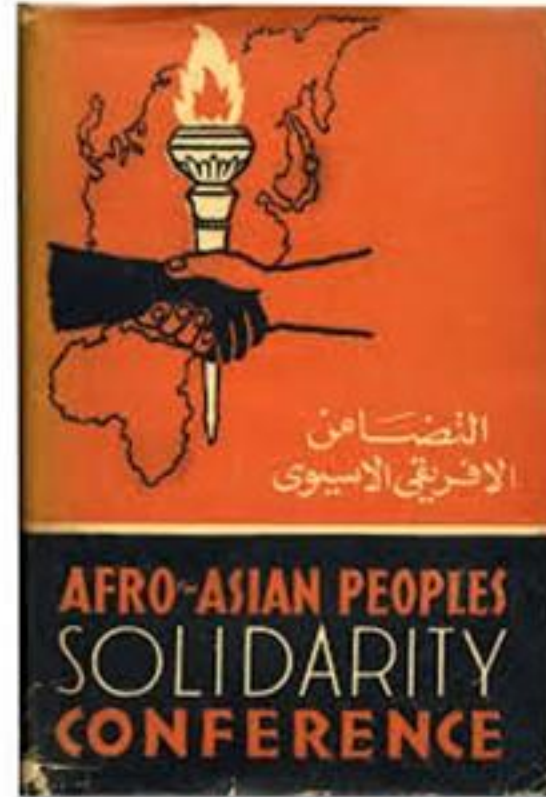
6 Prime Minister called for value addition to natural resources available in the country. He said that organic agro production is one of the many fields that offer vast potential for growth in Uganda

7 Prime Minister described skill development with a youth focus as a primary priority for Uganda.



PM MODI AT UGANDA PARLIAMENT

- 8 Prime Minister assured Uganda that India will supply zero defect machinery to aid growth in manufacturing in the country
- 9 India will open 18 new embassies across Africa
- 10 PM Modi also announced the donation of a badly-needed cancer therapy machine and loans worth \$200 million (171 million euros) for infrastructure and environmental projects



GUEST PRESIDENT VISIT TO INDIA

- 1** South African President Cyril Ramaphosa visited India as the Guest of Honor of India's Republic Day celebrations. It was a high-level delegation including ministers, senior officials and a 50-member business contingent.
- 2** Extensive talks on bilateral, regional and global issues of mutual interest strengthening the close relationship between India and South Africa.
- 3** The India-South Africa Business Forum was held on January 25
- 4** The South African President delivered the Gandhi-Mandela Freedom Lecture organized by Indian Council of World Affairs
- 5** The event coincides with Mahatma Gandhi's 150th birth anniversary,
- 6** The choice of the guest is thus, guided by a number of reasons – strategic, diplomatic, business interest and international geo-politics



GUEST PRESIDENT VISIT TO INDIA

IMPORTANCE OF SOUTH AFRICA FOR INDIA

- 1 South Africa is a key player in the BRICS grouping, and is one of the leaders in the African continent.
- 2 About 1.5 million Indian origin people live in South Africa while over 150 Indian companies have invested in South Africa.
- 3 India is among the top five trading partners of South Africa.
- 4 The bilateral trade has increased to USD 10.65 billion in 2018-19 from USD 9.38 billion in 2017-18



GUEST PRESIDENT VISIT TO INDIA

IMPORTANCE OF SOUTH AFRICA FOR INDIA

- 5 Moreover, in 2018, India completed 25 years of diplomatic relations with South Africa, 100th birth anniversary of Nelson Mandela and 125 years of Pietermaritzburg train incident.
- 6 The governments need to harness the potential of platforms like IBSA and BRICS. It can contribute to skill development, South-South cooperation and people-to-people contacts.



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